Three, India has established better relations with the United States and its allies (including in Europe, Japan, Australia, and Israel) than at any point in its history. These relations are broader than some of its old partnerships, as with the Soviet Union during the height of the Cold War, and now extend to military cooperation, business, education and technology. With the Anglophone world, in particular, India enjoys stronger relations by virtue of its large and growing diaspora. These improved relationships are also closely linked to another transformative change: India having achieved both nuclear security and legitimacy. The nuclear deterrent was an important objective in an era when India was much more insecure. Demonstrating a nuclear capability, followed by negotiations to not be commercially or technologically disadvantaged for its nuclear arsenal, removes major shackles on India's economic and technological development.

Four, India has exchanged the rhetoric of third-worldism for that of a rising power. Again, this has antecedents in the immediate post-Independence period but carries more credibility with the stronger performance of the Indian economy. In that sense, India's recent emphasis on the Global South is very different from that of Non-Alignment, in that it is much more an aspect of great power competition than a recusal from it. An India that had less hesitation in associating first with the BRICS (until that group's limitations became apparent), followed by the Quad, is indicative of this repositioning.

Finally, for all its progress, India faces a major strategic challenge in China. The People's Republic of China is a single-party state that continues to claim large tracts of Indian territory and whose economy has risen faster than India's since the 1980s. China's rise initially presented economic and institutional opportunities for India. But recent developments—on the disputed border, in the Indian Ocean region, on trade and economic issues, and at international institutions—have made clear the degree to which Beijing's policies offer major impediments to India's rise, its near abroad, its maritime security, its regional aspirations, and its global objectives.

While the major transformations in India's foreign policy between 1991 and the present have often been structural and cumulative, the historical